Ali Kaazempur-Mofrad

Citizenship: United States and Canada

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Education

University of California, Los Angeles (UCLA) — Los Angeles, CA
Ph.D. in Statistics, expected June 2027 — 2022–Present
Advisor: Xiaowu Dai

University of Toronto — Toronto, ON
Honours B.Sc., Major in Physics; Minors in Mathematics and Statistics — 2016–2021

Research Interests

- Decision-making under uncertainty & AI safety
- Market design & matching
- LLM evaluation, auditing & proper scoring
- Fairness in resource allocation

Publications & Manuscripts

Ali Kaazempur-Mofrad and Xiaowu Dai. "A Data Envelopment Analysis Approach for Assessing Fairness in Resource Allocation: Application to Kidney Exchange Programs." *The Annals of Applied Statistics*, 20(1):385–407, 2026.
[Paper] [Code]

Ali Kaazempur-Mofrad, Xiaowu Dai, and Xuming He. "A Statistical Market-Design Framework for Academic Job Markets." *arXiv:2604.14230*, 2026.
[Paper] [Code] [Project Website]

Ali Kaazempur-Mofrad, Xiaowu Dai, and Xuming He. "Beyond a Single Answer: Proper Scoring of LLM Uncertainty." Submitted, 2026.
[Code]
Preprint available upon request.

Presentations

Talks

"Beyond a Single Answer: Proper Scoring of LLM Uncertainty."
IMS International Conference on Statistics and Data Science (invited talk, Student Award session) — December 15–18, 2026 (upcoming)

Research overview: fairness in resource allocation, statistical market design, and proper scoring of LLM uncertainty.
Shapiro Statistics Student Seminar & Social, UCLA — October 8, 2026

"A Statistical Market-Design Framework for Academic Job Markets."
American Statistical Association (research presentation to leadership) — August 17, 2026
Statistics Student Seminar & Social (S4), UCLA — April 23, 2026

Posters

"Beyond a Single Answer: Proper Scoring of LLM Uncertainty."
Conference on Statistical Foundations of AI (CSFAI) — November 13, 2026 (upcoming)
StatsFest, UCLA Department of Statistics & Data Science — September 23, 2026

Awards & Fellowships

IMS ICSDS Student Travel Award 2026
IMS International Conference on Statistics and Data Science

CSFAI Travel Award (NSF-supported) 2026
Conference on Statistical Foundations of AI

Summer Mentored Research Fellowship 2023
UCLA Department of Statistics & Data Science

Teaching & Mentoring

Teaching Assistant, UCLA Department of Statistics & Data Science 2023–Present

- STATS 425: Large Language Models in Text Mining *(Graduate)*
- STATS 403: Mathematical Statistics *(Graduate)*
- STATS 140XP: Practice of Statistical Consulting
- STATS 102C: Introduction to Monte Carlo Methods
- STATS 102A: Introduction to Computational Statistics with R
- STATS 101A: Introduction to Data Analysis and Regression
- STATS 100C: Linear Models
- STATS 100B: Introduction to Mathematical Statistics
- STATS 13: Introduction to Statistical Methods for Life and Health Sciences
- STATS 10: Introduction to Statistical Reasoning

Research Mentoring

One master's student (Statistics); two undergraduates (Computer Science; Statistics and Data Science).

Professional Service

Journal Reviewer, *Journal of the American Statistical Association* (JASA), *Stat*, and *PLOS One*

Conference Organization Support 2026
Conference on Statistical Foundations of AI (CSFAI)

Mentor 2023–2026
ASA DataFest at UCLA

Director of Discretionary Funding 2024–2026
UCLA Graduate Students Association

Poster Judge May 2026
Undergraduate Poster Day, Undergraduate Interdisciplinary Research Association (UCLA)

Selected Graduate Coursework

ECON 211C: Game Theory and Economic Applications · STATS 211: Topics in Economics and Machine Learning · STATS 219: Topics in Reinforcement Learning · STATS 202B: Matrix Algebra and Optimization · STATS C260: Causal Inference for Health Data